Virasat

Helping families claim the money a parent left behind

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Problem. When a parent dies, heirs lose months or years working out which institution now holds each share certificate and deposit, which claim form applies, and in what order to file.

Solution. Virasat reads the family's old papers with an LLM, then passes only *human-confirmed* facts to deterministic code. The code traces company mergers, applies versioned claim rules and returns an ordered claim plan in which every step cites its source.

Who decides. The heir confirms facts. A CA or advocate handles succession documents. The registrar or bank makes the final decision. The AI decides nothing.

₹73,241 cr
unclaimed in bank deposits, insurance and mutual funds, Feb 2026 [1]

₹5,777 cr
returned to 22.95 lakh claimants in one 3-month campaign [1]

2 years, 5 leaves
one Nagpur family's claim for ₹1.8 lakh of shares

1. The area I explored, what surprised me, and why now

I looked at what happens to a person's deposits and shares after death, when the family doesn't know the details. I expected the hard part to be *finding* the money. It isn't. The money moves, and each move adds a new office, form and rulebook.



Figure 1. The money is never lost; it moves. Every arrow is a new institution the family has to discover on its own.

Companies die, but their shares don't

A certificate of a company that merged away is still a live claim on the company that absorbed it. When HDFC Ltd merged into HDFC Bank in 2023, every 25 shares became 42 [3]. After a rename, a split and a merger, a 1990s certificate tells a family nothing about what they own today.

The search portals exist, and families still fail

RBI's UDGAM searches unclaimed deposits across 30 banks; IRDAI and SEBI run similar tools. But RBI told the Supreme Court in May 2026 that UDGAM is *only* a search tool. The heir must still go to each bank and follow its procedure [4].

The rules change faster than people, or models, learn them

An LLM told me heirs need a succession certificate above ₹2 lakh of shares. That was SEBI's old limit; the January 2026 FAQ says ₹5 lakh per company (physical) and ₹15 lakh (demat) [5]. So rules live in a versioned store, never in the model.

The form is the easy part

IEPF's own FAQ says anyone literate can fill its form without help. The family I interviewed agreed. What took two years was knowing *which* form, for *which* company, in *what order*.

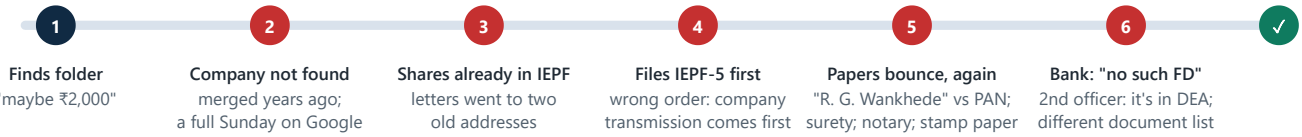
Why now

- The "Your Money, Your Right" campaign (Oct–Dec 2025) returned ₹5,777 crore through camps in 748 districts [1]. Demand is proven, but the camps were temporary.
- The Supreme Court is hearing a public-interest petition on how heirs find a deceased person's assets, and asked regulators to respond (May 2026) [4].
- SEBI and RBI simplified procedures in 2024–26, so the rules families and agents half-remember are already out of date.

2. The problem

A real claim, start to finish (practitioner interview, name changed)

Rajesh, 48, is an accounts executive in Nagpur. After his father, a government school teacher, died, the family found share certificates and one old fixed-deposit receipt in a plastic folder. His wife guessed they were worth ₹2,000–3,000. The family finally received about **₹1.8 lakh**, almost two years later.



What it cost: ~2 years · 4–5 half-day leaves (notary and tehsil work office hours only) · ₹300–500 per notary/stamp/courier round
an uncle who refused to be surety · an agent offering to "do everything" for 25% (₹45,000 of ₹1.8 lakh)
Outcome: ₹1.8 lakh received. Without stubbornness, it would still be lying there.

Figure 2. Rajesh's claim, 2020–2022. Red steps are where the family lost time to a missing fact, not a missing form.

> *"The money was never lost. It just kept shifting from company to company, office to office, and nobody tells you. The form is easy. Knowing which form, for which company, in what order, that took me two years and five leaves."*
>
> Rajesh, Nagpur (name changed)

Problem statement

When a family member dies, the legal heir must work out **which institution now holds each asset, which claim route applies, and in what order to file**. Today this is done by trial and error across companies, registrars, banks, notaries and government offices.

Who	Legal heirs, usually not finance professionals; sometimes helped by a CA.
Task	Turn a folder of old papers into a correct, ordered set of claims, one per institution.
How often	Once per death in a family with savings. India registers roughly 80 lakh to 1 crore deaths a year (Civil Registration System, 2020–21).
Cost today	Months to years, repeated leave, notary and courier costs, agents asking for 25%. The biggest cost is invisible: families who assume the amount is small and never start.

Out of scope

Deciding *who* the legal heir is (succession law; belongs to an advocate or court). Property, foreign assets and crypto. Family disputes. Filing claims on the family's behalf. **Version 1 covers physical shares and bank deposits only.**

What Virasat would have changed for Rajesh

Where he lost time	Virasat feature	Effect
Wife guessed "₹2,000"	Early value range	Families don't abandon claims they wrongly think are small
Company on certificate not found	Lineage graph	Successor company and registrar named in minutes, with source
Filed IEPF-5 before transmission	Sequencer	Steps shown in the order the institutions require
Name mismatch, surety, stamp paper	Rejection pre-check	Known rejection causes flagged before anything is posted
4–5 half-day leaves	Trip planner	All notary and tehsil tasks grouped into the fewest visits
Bank staff: "no such FD"	Cited printout	Heir shows the official DEA procedure at the counter

3. Solution design

Virasat turns the family's folder of papers into an **ordered, cited claim plan**: what each asset is today, who holds it, which documents are needed and in what order. The AI reads and matches. Code calculates and sequences. Humans confirm facts and make every legal decision.

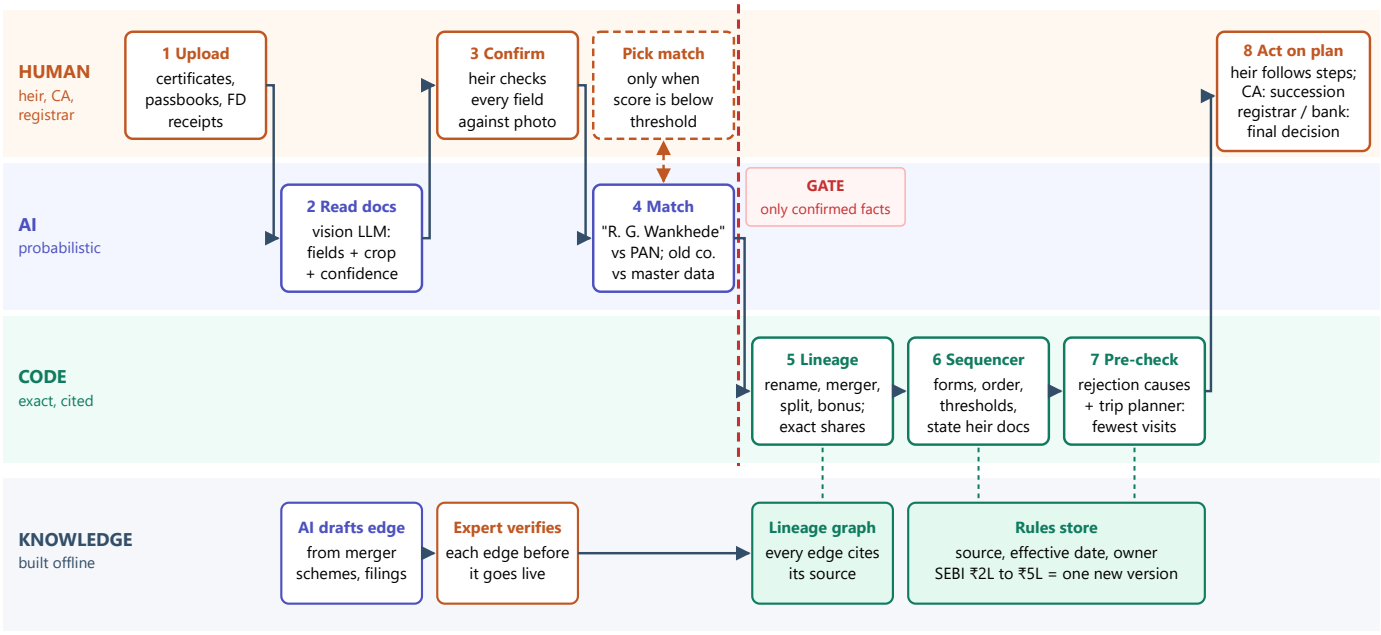


Figure 3. Architecture. The LLM never produces a ratio, amount or threshold; a human confirms everything it reads or matches.

Where knowledge lives, whether it must be exact, and who checks it

What	Lives in	Type	Who checks it	When it changes
Fields read from documents	Vision LLM output	PROBABILISTIC	Heir, against photo	Every new case
Name and company matches	Entity matcher	PROBABILISTIC	Heir, if score is low	Every new case
Renames, mergers, splits	Lineage graph (cited)	EXACT	Expert, edge by edge	New merger: add one edge
Thresholds, forms, step order	Versioned rules store	EXACT	Named rule owner	New version; old claims keep old rule
Share count and value	Calculator (code)	EXACT	Registrar, final amount	Recomputed from graph
Who the heir is	People	JUDGEMENT	Advocate; institution	Never automated

Output: an asset map (each lead *confirmed*, *likely* or *unknown*), a value range, and a printable step-by-step plan. Every line cites a rule or a document crop, so an auditor can check it without trusting the model. A company missing from the graph returns "lineage unknown", never a guess.

Why AI, and only in two places. The inputs are 30-year-old certificates, handwritten passbooks, regional languages and initials instead of names; rules and regex cannot read them. Everything after that is lookup, arithmetic and ordering, which code does better and can prove.

Alternatives I considered and rejected

Alternative considered	Why I rejected it
One LLM call: "what is this worth?"	Invents swap ratios; it gave me the stale ₹2 lakh threshold.
Retrieval over filings at query time	Ratios must be exact: extract once, verify, store with a citation.
Several cooperating agents	The pipeline is linear; agents add failure points, not capability.
Auto-scraping UDGAM and IEPF	Legal and terms-of-use risk; the heir runs searches we prepare.
Fine-tuning a model on claim rules	Freezes rules that change yearly; hides which version was used.

4. Weakest point, and risks

Weakest point: lineage-graph coverage. Listed companies after 2000 are well documented; older mergers, unlisted and struck-off companies are not. So the system is least certain on the oldest certificates, where families need it most. Mitigation: say "unknown", route to a human, and grow the graph from real cases.

Risk	How Virasat handles it
Wrong answers	Human confirms before any calculation; values shown as a range; unknown lineage is never guessed.
Outdated rules	Every rule has a source, effective date, owner and review date; overdue rules show a warning.
Confidential data	DPDP Act, 2023: Aadhaar masked, no-retention model provider, files deleted on closure. Prototype: synthetic data only.
Impostor fraud	Works only from documents the user holds; no open name search; the institution's KYC stays the real gate.
Liability	Procedural information with sources, not legal advice. Never decides who the heir is; routes to an advocate where the law requires. The deploying organisation owns the rules store.

5. Prototype test plan, and next steps

10 synthetic cases (made-up people, real cited corporate events):

1. Renamed company plus a stock split
2. HDFC Ltd into HDFC Bank (42:25)
3. Three-step chain: rename, merger, split
4. Struck-off company: expect "doubtful"
5. Initials vs full name ("R. G. Wankhede")
6. Fractional entitlement, paid as cash
7. Boundary: ₹4.9 vs ₹5.1 lakh, physical shares
8. IEPF-5 filed before transmission
9. FD in DEA Fund that a branch denies
10. Faded passbook; Hindi-language document

Measured per case: fields read correctly, successor found, share count exact, steps in the right order, rejection causes caught, and whether it says "unknown" instead of guessing. A confident wrong answer scores worse than an honest "unknown".

Before spending more time:

- Ask 2–3 registrars and one bank claims desk for real rejection reasons.
- Count how many old certificates are unlisted or struck-off. If most, the graph is the wrong bet.
- Pick the deployer: bank desks and district camps, not a consumer app. Another country only swaps the rules store and lineage sources (US: state treasuries).

Sources. [1] PIB, Ministry of Finance, Rajya Sabha reply, March 2026. [2] PIB press note, "Your Money, Your Right", December 2025. [3] HDFC–HDFC Bank scheme of amalgamation, effective 1 July 2023. [4] The Hindu, "30 banks integrated with UDGAM portal…", 5 May 2026. [5] SEBI FAQs, January 2026, Q72 (transmission without nomination).

Appendix: what I added beyond the AI

Where AI helped

Claude (in Cursor): reading the assignment, brainstorming, finding official sources, drafting text and diagrams. Key prompts: "*Read the assignment properly… understand what the company wants*"; "*suggest unique, not usual ideas… catchy, different, crazy*"; and the Rajesh interview with "*what does this change in the design?*"

What I rejected or corrected

- Generic first ideas (GST, TDS): pushed for something new.
- The LLM's ₹2 lakh threshold: SEBI's January 2026 FAQ says ₹5 lakh / ₹15 lakh.
- AIS as a discovery source: unverified, so kept as an open question.
- "Find assets" framing: the interview showed sequencing is the real problem.

What came from me

- The Rajesh interview. His pain points became the pre-check, trip planner and cited printout, which I then worked out with the AI.
- Choosing this problem, and narrowing version 1 to shares and deposits.

One thing I'd stand behind without AI

Share counts come from a cited graph and a calculator, never a model. By hand: 100 HDFC Ltd × 42/25 = 168 HDFC Bank shares. Fractions are paid in cash. One wrong ratio puts a wrong number on a sworn indemnity bond.